Phase 0, Revit, and AI: how the pieces fit

Prepared by Keys2TheWeb for a2o Architecture · October 16, 2026

THE SHORT VERSION

a2o is moving from AutoCAD LT to Revit. Phase 0 ($3,000) does the two things that have to happen anyway, early and calmly: it takes the repetitive writing off the drafters now, and it gets a2o's drafting standards written down so the Revit setup starts from an answer instead of a question.

Once a2o is in Revit, most of the AI help the firm will want is either already built into Revit or available free through an add-in that lets Claude work inside the model. Keys2TheWeb's job is to supply what those tools cannot: a2o's own standards, voice, and Keys-specific know-how, and to make the pieces work together. That is why the plan buys the generic tools and builds only the a2o-specific layer.

PHASE 0: WHAT THE $3,000 COVERS

1. The a2o Draft Assistant, already built. A private web app that writes General Notes, Specification Sections, and Schedules in a2o's voice. It works from a2o's own past documents, not generic boilerplate. Type a short brief and the project facts, get a draft, edit it, copy it onto the sheet. Save good ones and reuse them. The tool exists today; the Phase 0 work is loading a2o's real documents and tuning it to the firm's conventions, then sitting with a drafter on a live project until it earns its place.

2. a2o's drafting standards, one page per item. Title block, layers and line weights, block library, annotation, and note language, reviewed by a2o's lead drafter and handed over as a2o's own document. This is the input every Revit template builder asks for first.

3. Overflow drafting help during the changeover, as needed.

What Phase 0 is not. It does not build Revit templates or family libraries, which the proposal keeps on a2o's track (in-house, a Revit specialist, or Autodesk onboarding). It does not automate inside AutoCAD LT, which cannot be extended. It is relief around LT, built so nothing is thrown away when Revit arrives.

WHERE CLAUDE AND NONICATAB FIT ONCE REVIT IS IN PLACE

NonicaTab is a free Revit add-in from Nonica (Autodesk Marketplace, Revit 2020 through 2027). Its "AI Connector" lets Claude, on the desktop or in Claude Code, work directly on the open Revit model through about fifty predefined actions. According to Nonica's listing, those cover:

- Reading and checking the model: parameters on any element, which views sit on which sheets, element counts, missing data.
- Selecting and editing in bulk: renumbering, renaming, filling in parameters across many elements at once.
- Documentation setup: creating sheets and sections, placing views on sheets, bulk duplicating and renaming views and sheets.

It does not draw. Nothing in the listing creates walls or places doors; it manages and documents a model that people draw. Exact capabilities should be confirmed in Claude's tool list after installing, before anyone relies on them.

What that means in practice for a2o:

- *Template and sheet-set assembly gets cheaper.* The tedious half of a Revit template (sheet lists, view structure, naming, standard parameters) can be driven by Claude from a2o's standards document, while a person makes the judgment calls. That is work Keys2TheWeb would otherwise have scripted by hand.
- *The Draft Assistant's output has a path into Revit.* Schedules and notes generated by the app can be applied to the model and sheets, rather than retyped.
- *Everyday chores stop costing drafter time.* "Renumber the doors on level 2." "Find every room with no finish assigned." "Duplicate the sheet set for the addition."

Revit itself is adding AI. Autodesk's 2027 release includes an assistant inside Revit for sheet and schedule management, element operations, automated documentation, and drawing-compliance checks. a2o should start on the newest Revit it can get.

Sketch-to-model tools such as Civly exist and sell for roughly A$2,000 per seat per month, with code checks for Australian, US IBC, and EU codes but nothing for the Florida Building Code, flood and wind provisions, or HARC. Worth a look later; not something to build.

WHY THIS SAVES MONEY OVER TIME

Buy the generic, build only the specific. General-purpose Revit AI is being built by Autodesk and offered free by add-ins like NonicaTab. Paying anyone to recreate it would be money spent on something a2o will get anyway. Keys2TheWeb's work stays on what no vendor can supply: a2o's voice, a2o's standards, Keys and HARC specifics, and the glue between tools.

The standards pay three times. Written once in Phase 0, they feed the Draft Assistant now, the Revit template in Phase 1, and any conversion of a2o's own DWGs into Revit later. Without them, each of those is a separate discovery exercise.

Drafter hours, in a2o's own numbers. The honest way to size the return is to fill in the firm's figures:

INPUT	A2O'S NUMBER
Hours per project now spent writing or copy-editing notes, specs, and schedules	____
Hours per project after the Draft Assistant (typically a fraction)	____
Projects per year	____
Loaded hourly cost of a drafter	____

Two to three hours saved per project, across a normal year of projects, repays Phase 0 several times over before the Revit template work begins. Fewer stale copy-paste errors are a bonus that does not show in the arithmetic.

Every step is optional. a2o can stop after Phase 0 with the tool, the standards, and the changeover support in hand. Phase 1 (standards into the Revit templates, rollout coordination, $1,500 to $2,500) and Phase 2 (a real-project assessment of what Revit and the free tools still leave undone, $2,500) are priced from evidence, not guesses, and each is a separate decision.

WHAT KEYS2THEWEB NEEDS TO BEGIN

1. a2o's current drafting standards and two or three typical past projects (DWG and PDF).
2. The go-ahead on Phase 0 and the $3,000 invoice.